

DREAM — Full Journey Build Brief

Implementation brief for Claude Code. The complete DREAM framework end-to-end: Dating → Relationship → Engaged → Married, plus transitions, exit/re-entry, and lateral entry. Supersedes the Relationship-only brief.

Naming rules (enforce in all copy & identifiers): use "playbook," "plan," or "agreement of understanding" — never "contract" (except in disclaimer text stating what the playbook is *not*). Tagline: "Dare to Dream." Slogan: "Built for meaningful relationships that last — not just matches that spark." DREAM is a **framework, not a mandate** — where a couple chooses to arrive (Relationship, Engaged, or Married) is their choice.

1 • The whole journey as one state machine

Model the user's progress as a single stateful journey. Stages share machinery (calendar, Guru, playbook, reports) — build once, parameterize per stage. Everything is **advisory**; the only blocking gate is the entry consent step.

```
// Top-level journey states a user (or couple) can occupy
JourneyState: 'onboarding' | 'dating' | 'relationship' | 'engaged' | 'married'
              | 'exiting' | 'cooloff' | 're-entry'

// Stages after Dating share one Couple record; stage is a field, not a new table
Couple {
  id, partnerA_id, partnerB_id,
  stage: JourneyState,           // relationship | engaged | married
  enteredVia: 'progression' | 'lateral', // lateral = joined together
  startDate, stageWeekIndex,
  exclusivityAckA, exclusivityAckB,
  consentBlock: { signedA, signedB, biometricA, biometricB, version, stageTaken },
  roadProfileRef, playbookRef, calendarRef
}
```

2 • Shared machinery (build once, reuse every stage)

Component	Notes / reuse
Calendar	Carries over from Dating. Types: availability · obligation · date · travel (solo / partner_solo / together). Per-entry shared opt-in.
ROAD profile	Set at Relationship entry; carries forward to Engaged & Married. Re-runnable if a couple wants to refresh, but not forced. Keep light — do not add belief-system fields.
Guru	Four pillars (air&resolve · romance · expense · mediator) run in every stage. Stage-specific topics layered on (see §4).
Playbook	Three tiers (generic · Vision-unlocked · Guru-custom) + bold consent block. Reaffirmed/extended per stage, not rewritten from scratch.
Weekly report	Qualitative, four-view scoring, sorted/open buckets, new-vs-repeated tags, opt-in resources. Same engine every stage.

3 • Stage transitions (the gates)

Every forward transition is a **soft, Guru-checkpointed gate** — never auto-advanced, never hard-forced. Each transition re-takes the biometric consent block (new **stageTaken** value).

Transition	Trigger	What happens
Dating → Relationship	Mutual match confirmation (Getting-to-Know Agreement closes → Partnership Vision opens)	Exclusivity + previously-optional Stats/Vision become mandatory. ROAD set. Consent block signed.
Relationship → Engaged	Guru soft-checkpoint (e.g. at/after week 16) — both opt in	ROAD carries forward. Playbook reaffirmed + extended. Consent re-taken. Guru topics shift (see §4).
Engaged → Married	Guru soft-checkpoint — both opt in	ROAD carries forward. Playbook reaffirmed. Consent re-taken. Guru shifts to sustaining rhythm.

Keep the **gate mechanic identical** across transitions — a reusable `advanceStage()` that: verifies mutual opt-in → re-takes consent → carries ROAD/playbook/calendar forward → updates `stage` → re-parameterizes Guru topics. Don't build three bespoke flows.

4 · Stage-specific Guru topics (light, evolutionary — no rigid frameworks)

Design principle (important): deliberately do NOT encode belief-system matrices (political leaning, religion, feminism-vs-traditional). Alignment emerges through lived experience. Stage topics are conversation prompts Guru surfaces, not compatibility tests. Keep it open to evolve.

Stage	Guru topics layered on (beyond the four pillars)
Relationship	Vibe/chemistry check-ins; shared hobbies/activities; the four pillars in full.
Engaged	Wedding/celebration planning; deeper family integration; festivals & how each likes to celebrate them (the family/festivals thread lands here).
Married	The living shared calendar of meaning — birthdays, anniversaries, festivals, "how we celebrate us." Guru sustains rhythm rather than gating.

```
GuruTopic {
  couple_id, stage, kind: 'pillar' | 'stage_topic',
  key: 'air_resolve' | 'romance' | 'expense' | 'mediator'
    | 'wedding_planning' | 'family' | 'festivals' | 'milestones' | ...,
  // topics are additive per stage; never remove the four pillars
}
```

5 · Exit / failure path (structured closure, not open-ended)

When a couple parts at any stage, route to a **structured exit**, not a silent unmatched.

```
Exit {
  couple_id, initiatedBy, stageAtExit,
  status: 'interview' | 'feedback' | 'cooloff' | 'complete',
  exitInterviewDone: bool,
  feedbackA_raw, feedbackB_raw,          // private inputs
  guruSynthesisForA, guruSynthesisForB, // mediated growth points
  cooloffEnds: date                      // 1-2 weeks mandated
}
```

- **Exit interview** before any re-entry — facilitated closure if needed. Not open-ended.
- **Guru-mediated feedback (critical):** each partner's raw feedback is NEVER shown directly to the other. Guru synthesizes it into constructive, depersonalized growth points. This protects against post-breakup cruelty/blame while preserving the growth loop.
- **Mandated 1-2 week cool-off** before re-entry — time to process/synthesize. Enforce at the data layer (block re-entry until `cooloffEnds`).
- **Philosophy in code comments:** the loop exists so the next experience isn't a repeat of the same pattern — surfaced gently, never preachy. No blocking on "you must change," just the feedback + cool-off.

6 • Lateral entry (the invite fork)

Already-partnered couples enter via the **invite flow**, not the singles pool. The choice is made at invite time.

```
Invite {
  fromUser_id, toContact,
  mode: 'start_together' | 'join_pool',
  targetStage: 'relationship' | 'engaged' | 'married' | null // null for join_pool
}
```

Mode	Behaviour
join_pool	Standard single-seeking flow — full onboarding, Vision/Stats/Skills, REACH, Dating.
start_together	Couple enters directly at chosen stage (expedite). Married couples can experience DREAM richly — "retaking vows." Creates a Couple with enteredVia: 'lateral'.

Lateral entry rules: full BGV + consent block still required for both partners (safety floor is constant regardless of entry point). **Skip REACH** — it's a searching-phase tool and they aren't searching. ROAD/playbook/calendar set up at the entered stage as normal.

7 • Full data model (consolidated)

```
User { id, journeyState, verification:{ bgvStatus, consentVersion }, stats, vision, skills }
Couple { id, partnerA_id, partnerB_id, stage, enteredVia, startDate,
  stageWeekIndex, exclusivityAckA/B, consentBlock, road/playbook/calendar refs }
RoadProfile { user_id, couple_id, routine:{work,fitness} } // O/A/D = CalendarEntry
CalendarEntry { id, couple_id, owner_id, type, travelMode, start, end, title, shared }
Playbook { couple_id, stage, tierGeneric[], tierVision[], tierCustom[], consentBlock }
Difference { id, couple_id, raisedBy, text, tag, status, consentToShare, weekRaised }
GuruTopic { couple_id, stage, kind, key }
WeeklyReport { id, couple_id, stage, weekIndex, appreciations[], sorted[], open[],
  views:{ownA,guruOnA,ownB,guruOnB,combined,guruOnPair}, gapNotes[],
  romanceNotes, expenseCompliant, optInResources[] }
Exit { couple_id, initiatedBy, stageAtExit, status, feedback*_raw,
  guruSynthesisFor*, cooloffEnds }
Invite { fromUser_id, toContact, mode, targetStage }
```

8 • Cross-cutting rules (global)

- **Advisory, never coercive** — log-off/skip/deregister anytime; only the entry consent gate blocks.
- **Consent-gated sharing** at the data layer — availability, travel, aired differences default private.
- **Input privacy** — self-reports, Guru raw notes, and exit feedback are private; only composed/synthesized outputs are shared.
- **Guru is a guide** — comfort/suggest/mediate/reflect; never dictate or judge. All output advisory.
- **Verification floor is constant** — BGV + consent required at every entry point (progression or lateral).
- **Keep stage logic evolutionary** — no rigid belief/ideology encoding; topics are additive prompts.

9 • Build order (suggested)

1. Journey state machine + User / Couple models.
2. Shared machinery: calendar, ROAD, playbook, Guru service, weekly-report engine.
3. Dating stage (separate spec) + Dating→Relationship gate.
4. Reusable advanceStage() — powers all three forward transitions.
5. Stage topic parameterization (Engaged/Married Guru topics).
6. Exit path: interview → Guru-mediated feedback → cool-off → re-entry.
7. Lateral-entry invite fork (BGV + consent, skip REACH).
8. Instrument everything (analytics from day one).

Complete backend design reference for Dare to Dream, superseding the Relationship-only brief. Open dependencies to stub, not build here: minimum-viable-pool gate (launch infra), pricing/WTP, BGV vendor comms specifics. Guru copy/voice follows the advisory, non-judgmental DREAM voice.